

Yitong (Eric) Lu

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

Master of Applied Economics and Data Science

Philadelphia, PA

Expected December 2027

Pennsylvania State University

Bachelor of Accounting, Finance, and Economics (B.S.)

State College, PA

2022-2026

- **GPA:** 3.74/4.0; **Dean's List** (for seven consecutive semesters); **Key Courses:** Intermediate Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Intro Econometrics, Statistics, Tech Calculus, Auditing, Financial Acctg, Principles of Taxation, Managerial Acctg, Corporate Fin, Security Analysis and Portfolio Mgt, Derivative Markets, Business Analytics, Game Theory, Advanced Fin Modelling, and Business Data Mgt

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

FOUNDER FINANCING SERVICES CO., LTD.

Intern in Finance Department

Beijing, China

June 2023 - July 2023

- Assisted in fixed assets related data collation and ledger maintenance, to ensure that the accounts are consistent with the facts.
- Supported the preparation of monthly and quarterly asset management statements to facilitate financial analysis and reporting.
- Used the OA system to input and review expense reimbursement documents.
- Assisted with data summary and quarterly fixed assets reports to improve reporting accuracy and timeliness.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The Pennsylvania State University, Department of Economics

Research Assistant, Instructor: Prof. Seula Kim

October 2025-Present

- Analyze geographic price dispersion and inflation across U.S. markets using NielsenIQ Consumer Panel data.
- Construct DMA-year population and expenditure shares across household income groups for regional empirical analysis.
- Clean and preprocess large-scale household purchase data in Stata and construct household-level and region-level price measures.
- Incorporate BLS Consumer Expenditure Survey food expenditure weights to construct income-weighted regional expenditure measures.
- Analyze whether regional price dispersion is driven by retailer composition or income heterogeneity, controlling for retailer fixed effects.

The Pennsylvania State University, Department of Accounting

Research Assistant, Instructor: Prof. Jingwen Yang

January 2026-May 2026

- Constructed and cleaned large-scale datasets by merging Audit Analytics audit-firm data with employee-level Glassdoor records using fuzzy matching techniques in Stata.
- Calculated office-level employee turnover rates across major U.S. accounting firms, supporting empirical research on auditor human capital and audit quality.
- Performed SAS-to-Stata data conversion and standardized firm name, office city, and fiscal-year identifiers for cross-database linkage.
- Processed geographic location data using ArcGIS to conduct distance-based analysis and matching among audit-firm office locations and related entities.

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Technical Skills: Stata, R, Python, SQL, ERD Modelling, Excel (VBA), Access, Tableau, and ArcGIS

Languages: Native in Mandarin and Proficient in English

Interests: Applied Microeconomics, Industrial Organization, Price Measurement, and Consumer Behavior

Other: GRE: 327+4.5